

'The world has changed...' — Unlocking Teen Perspectives on Technological Futures through Design Fiction Workshops

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Abstract

Eliciting youth perspectives on technology presents unique challenges, as traditional research methods often feel formal, abstract, or disconnected from teens' lived experiences. Building on HCI research engaged with present-day sociotechnical experiences, our work examines teens' impressions of their technological futures through design fiction. In this study, we conducted design fiction workshops with 17 high school students, resulting in 12 stories exploring potential technological futures. We identified three major themes via thematic analysis: the exacerbation of social inequities, perceptions of technology-intertwined adulthood, and the normalized omnipresence of technology. Through our playful approach to design fiction, our study enabled participants to creatively explore sociotechnical topics that might be difficult to discuss. This work highlights design fiction as an insightful method for understanding youth's nuanced views on technology.

CCS Concepts

• Human-centered computing → Empirical studies in HCI; • Social and professional topics;

Keywords

youth and technology, design fiction, speculative futuring

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1 Introduction

Researchers face challenges around engaging and eliciting teens' perspectives on technology [1, 19, 21, 39]. CHI has explored the value of participatory methods in understanding the delicate transitions of teens between childhood and adulthood [13, 19, 20, 24, 28, 29]. Design fiction is a research method characterized by its diverse uses and plural applications, making it a versatile tool for engaging with complex populations and speculative futures [4, 7, 34, 39]. This includes applying design fiction as a tool for reflecting on and critiquing society [17, 18], a narrative examined through close reading [5, 25, 38], a method for generating scenarios and personas [12, 14], or a participatory approach to engage study participants [2, 30, 41]. In this study, we employ design fiction as both a speculative and a participatory method to better understand our participants' perspectives about their technological futures, addressing the challenges of effectively engaging young people in human-computer interaction (HCI) research.

Because design fiction asks its authors to playfully explore the speculative, this approach allows writers to evaluate their sociopolitical contexts in new ways. In the past, researchers have used design fiction to explore sensitive topics like workplace practices [40], racism [11], romance and intimacy [35, 36], chronic illness [32, 33], and societal collapse [37]. One key reason that design fiction encourages exploring sensitive topics is that it allows authors to reflect on the ramifications of future technologies, without having to concretely design or implement the technologies themselves [3, 7–9, 16]. Through design fiction, our participants explored their pasts and futures, imagining themselves in different timelines and granting them unique access to recontextualize their lived experiences across time.

In this study, we conducted in-person design fiction workshops with 17 high school students in San Francisco, resulting in 12 design fiction stories revolving around possible technological futures. We draw upon past studies that have used Black Mirror episodes as probes to explore technological futures [21, 22, 31]. The twelve design fiction stories written by teens revealed three primary perspectives around technology and the future: the exacerbation of social inequities by technology, perceptions of technologically-intertwined adulthood, and the omnipresence of technology as an embedded

and unstoppable force. Participants frequently depicted technology as worsening societal divides, with stories illustrating heightened socio-economic disparities, exploitative labor systems, and data-driven barriers to human connection. Teens portrayed technology as an all-powerful, state-wielded force with minimal human agency, highlighting themes of inevitability and determinism. Although researchers have often emphasized youth as protagonists in design fiction stories to empower their participation [23, 26, 39], none of our participants chose to depict youth as protagonists in their stories. Specifically, their narratives of adulthood focused on the complexities of consumerism, social connections and domestic life, emphasizing how technology mediates these spheres.

Drawing from our findings, we discuss ways we can empower teens to take control of their technological futures through civic education and digital literacy. We reflect on how design fiction enables teens to creatively engage with time and technology, surfacing critical perspectives on power dynamics, inequity, and human agency in a tech-saturated world.

2 Methodological Approach

To understand teens' contemporary perspectives on their technological futures, we conducted three workshops in November 2023 in partnership with a local youth community organization which conducts programming about leadership, public health, civic engagement, and technology. Two sessions were conducted in public high schools, while another session was conducted at a youth-designed community center for young people ages 14-25, including drop-in services for those experiencing homelessness, sexual exploitation, and foster care or the juvenile justice system. All of the programs we visited were year-long cohorts that meet weekly to learn about social justice, substance abuse, and health equity in San Francisco, California, United States of America.

We shared information about the study before each session, and potential participants indicated their interest by providing their parent and/or guardian's contact information. After parents/guardians gave consent for their children to participate, participants were invited to the workshop. Each workshop lasted 90 minutes with a break halfway through the session. We collected recordings of the workshop, along with the notes, stories, and drawings that participants produced during the session. Participants received monetary compensation through the community organization for their year-long participation in their respective programs, and were not directly compensated by our research team. We received approval from our university's Institutional Review Board for this research.

2.1 Participants

2.1.1 Community Center A. In this workshop, we had 6 participants ages 16-17 (4 girls, 2 boys), with the following racial demographics: White (2), Latino (2), East Asian (1), South Asian (1). Before the workshop at the youth community center, the first author introduced herself and the activity at the preceding meeting so that potential participants could have an opportunity to ask questions about the research.

2.1.2 High School B. In this workshop, we had 3 participants ages 15-17 (2 girls, 1 boy), with the following racial demographics: Latino

(1), East Asian (1), Southeast Asian (1). In 2019-2020, this high school was majority Asian (56%) and Latino (16.6%), with 49.6% of students enrolled classified as socioeconomically disadvantaged, 13.6% as English learners, and 3.4% as homeless.

2.1.3 High School C. In this workshop, we had 8 participants ages 14-18 (4 girls, 3 boys, 1 genderfluid student), with the following racial demographics: Latino (5), East Asian (3). In 2019-2020, this high school was majority Latino (57.1%) and African American (15%) with 56.8% of students enrolled classified as socioeconomically disadvantaged, 38.6% classified as English learners, and 7% classified as homeless.

2.2 Study Protocol

To guide our design fiction workshops, we drew upon past studies which used episodes of the science fiction television series *Black Mirror* to explore technological futures [6, 21, 22, 31]. We adapted an open-source slide deck for conducting speculative ethics classroom activities with *Black Mirror*, which has been used in K-12 and university settings [27]. This teaching activity asks students to write their own episode pitches in the style of *Black Mirror*, using design fiction to explore ethical issues in technology.

To give participants context about the television series, the slides introduced the activity by comparing episode synopses of *Black Mirror* to current controversial technologies. The introduction explores social credit scoring in the episode "Nosedive," memory recording systems in "The Entire History of You," and parental location-tracking of children in "Arkangel." Afterwards, we showed a 2 minute clip of *Black Mirror* episode "White Christmas," which applies the concept of Internet blocking to criminal justice. In the clip of the episode, people who committed crimes see everyone as white, static silhouettes, and everyone else sees them as red silhouettes. Although *Black Mirror* is recommended for ages 17 and older, we only presented age-appropriate videos and synopses of the episodes, and reviewed the presentation with the youth program coordinators before the workshops. While we expected the specific episodes to influence the stories, students produced a diverse range of technologies.

After students reflected on the value of speculative fiction such as *Black Mirror*, students worked in small groups to write their own design fiction episode pitches. Most participants worked in groups of 2-5, while others chose to work alone. First, students brainstormed potential technologies that could exist 15-20 years in the future, and then each group shared their ideas with the rest of the class. Next, students came up with potential social, legal, and ethical implications of their near future technology, prompted to search for news headlines as inspiration. Afterwards, students were instructed to come up with a story where a situation and main character could illustrate the technology they explored. We asked each group to write a 100-200 word story, and allotted 30-45 minutes for participants to write their pitches.

Groups then shared their stories with the class, and some students chose to supplement their writings with hand-drawn pictures. We led a guided discussion around the stories using "speculative pointers"—age-appropriate open-ended "what if?" questions meant to engage teens in speculative exercises [15].

2.3 Data Analysis

We analyzed the 12 design fictions written by the groups through Braun and Clarke's reflexive thematic analysis approach to understand primary perspectives and motifs which surfaced in teens' speculated futures [10]. While there are various alternative methods for evaluating design fictions [4], our intention was not for teens to design solutions or narrative provocations for us to evaluate; rather, we were interested in how the evoked themes could shape our understanding of teens' personal concerns and hopes. As such, we believed reflexive thematic analysis could be appropriately applied to the data.

After familiarizing ourselves with the stories, the authors conducted one pass of open coding individually, then came together to iterate and refine the produced codes. Through a visual mapping process, we organized and clustered codes to reveal emergent themes present in the stories.

3 Findings

From the twelve design fictions that groups wrote, we found three primary themes: technology furthering contemporary social inequities, teen perceptions of technologically-intertwined adulthood, and normalized, omnipresent technology.

3.1 Technology Exacerbating Social Inequities

Participants' stories (S3, S6, S7, S10, S11) described technological development to worsen social divides, power imbalances, and global inequities. S3 and S10 described further social stratification by way of leveraging citizen data and enforcing data-driven social barriers. In S3, citizens are assigned a digital profile formed by their biodata, and need this profile "to enroll in school...and use any social media accounts." In S10, every person has an "attractiveness number above their heads" calculated from others' ratings; lower ratings equate to fewer opportunities, and "certain people cannot interact with people of higher numbers." These stories suggest that technology may create a more divided society, especially when technology is used to quantify subjective measures like attractiveness.

S7 and S11 explicitly illustrated worlds with widened socioeconomic divides. In S7, a character "O" has a "FRND (Fully Robotic Neural Database) that basically does everything [...] including shopping... choosing [a] meal, [washing] clothes and dishes..." while O's neighbor is the sole breadwinner and has to provide for her two sons, "resulting in her not being able to afford a FRND." In S11, participants described a society where financial systems are technologically automated, particularly to defend establishments from shoplifting and deny access for the poor: "All grocery stores do not let you in unless you have money. Facial recognition tracks your finances... Poor people cannot go into stores or buy food, leaving many starved corpses at stores..." Both of these stories contend with wealth disparities that are further exacerbated by technologies, where technology acts as the enforcer of class divides, but also as a luxury commodity for the upper classes.

S6 investigated a global impact, where teens imagined an "age of obsessive online shopping" reliant on "third world workers, adults and children alike," leading to forced labor and mass death. Participants saw dangerous possibilities in how technology can be used

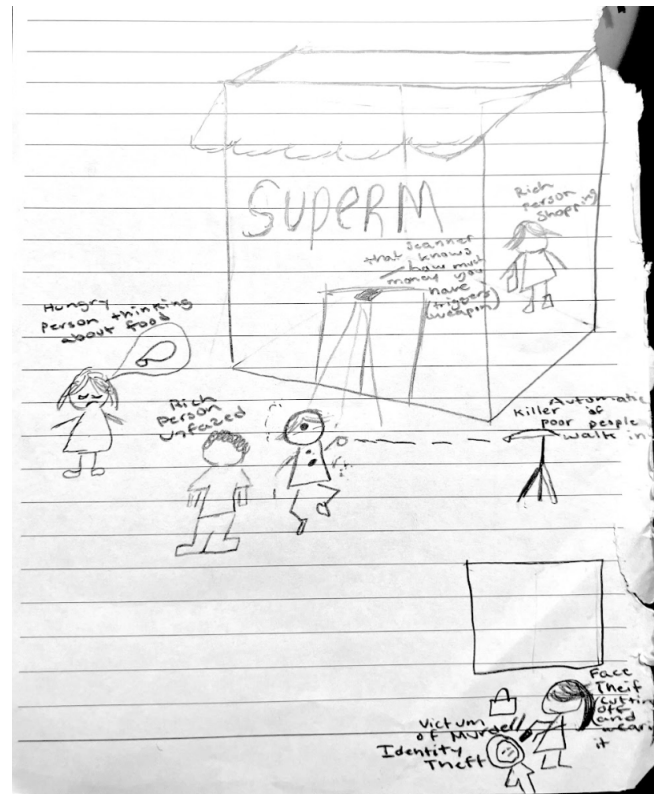


Figure 1: Participants' concept drawings for S11. This drawing shows a scene at a supermarket, surrounded by a hungry person thinking about food and an unfazed rich person. Outside of the supermarket, there is a machine that kills lower-class people upon entry. This machine is triggered by a scanner that knows how much money each customer has. The drawing also depicts a thief cutting off people's faces and wearing them to circumvent the machine, thereby changing the thief's class and status.

to exacerbate crises and enforce disparities across class hierarchies and global economies.

3.2 A Technologically-Intertwined Adulthood

While teens were tasked with envisioning technologies 15-20 years in the future, only one of the stories explicitly involved schools, teenagers, or young people of the future. Instead, their stories focused on responsibilities typically associated with adulthood or parenthood, such as intimacy, consumerism, and homemaking.

3.2.1 Social Connection and Romance. Dating and romance ruled the technological futures that participants imagined. Technology complicates social connection and dating in these design fictions by providing data-driven tools for choosing a partner and presenting a person as desirable, but also creating more social rifts by standing in for human interactions.

In S2, a new technology which allows people to visualize another person's past, present, and poor choices debuts, leading the

main character to view her fiancé's menu against his will and subsequently jeopardize their relationship. In S10, each person has an attractiveness number above their heads determined by the ratings of others. These stories seem to build upon our contemporary apps for online dating, illustrating tools for people to determine compatibility through public and data-driven profiles. However, they also suggest concerns about invasions of privacy (S2), as well as shallow perceptions of beauty translating to tangible social consequences (S10).

These stories reflected tensions between human vulnerability and automated perfection. In S1, the protagonist Malik anticipates going on a date in a world where robots and AI perform most services, while humans typically stay at home. Despite his hopes of human interaction, he finds that his date is also a robot. In S12, an international student Jerry has the widely-used iTalk device which allows people to "*formulate professionally perfect responses*" during conversations. He runs into a problem on his Tinder date when his iTalk malfunctions. In these worlds, technology replaces core aspects of emotional connection and partnership, erecting barriers to the level of human connection and authenticity we have in our contemporary world.

3.2.2 Financial Power and Consumerism. Participants designed technologies that complicated consumptive activities, like grocery shopping and online shopping (S3, S6, S7, S11). As teens looked toward their futures, they anticipated financial management in tandem with making choices as consumers. On the other hand, their stories positioned control and access as complicated by technological intervention. In S6, increasing demand for online shopping forces an exploitative labor market, where many workers are pushed to death in dangerous working conditions and industrial warehouses replace the once flourishing natural environment. In S3, personal data profiles enact more restrictions on opening a bank account. While these stories envision teens' futures as consumers, they also explore the perils of technology at two ends of the spectrum: enforcing barriers to financial power and accessing basic needs, or facilitating over-consumption and massively exploitative markets.

3.2.3 Home-Making and the Domestic Sphere. Teenagers envisioned technologies that facilitated home-making tasks like cleaning, cooking, and other domestic responsibilities. Participants were concerned about the reliance that home-making technologies enable, and how people might respond if those technologies break down. In S5, a family adopts a chore robot who soon kills the mother and disguises herself as a replacement, hiding within the family for years and eventually murdering them as well. S7, depicting the FRND robot, also ends with members of society who suffer from an inability to do domestic chores themselves, while those who provided for their families without FRNDs thrive. Participants problematized technologically-mediated domestic labor, exploring the dangers of unreliable technology for these important and intimately domestic tasks. The stories frame home-making as something people should ultimately learn how to do and take responsibility for themselves.

3.3 Normalized Omnipresence of Technology

In teens' design fictions, technologies appeared to have all-expansive power over the general population. Often, the future technologies emerged from unseen sources or were well-established prior to the beginning of each short story. While some stories discuss ubiquitous technologies as employed by the government, in others they just appear: for S2, the group wrote, "*She has her perfect fairytale life, except when a new technology debuts.*" Only one story, S3, mentions a specific software development company: "*The second you are born, the government has partnered with Apple...*"

Stories cited the government as the explicit (S3, S4, S7) or implicit (S11) enforcer of technology, positioning fictional technologies as state-wielded weapons for civic control or surveillance. In these stories, the government has pervasive, undeniable access to private and biological data as an input to the technologies they employ, such as "*biodata like fingerprints, blood samples*" in S3; vocal recordings, human memory, and personal secrets in S4; and public facial recognition in S11. In S7, the government ultimately has the power to shut down or change technology at its whim. The governments' overbearing orientation to data in these stories could reflect teen concerns about public agency and participation in technological decision-making.

3.3.1 Problems of Reliance, Replacement, and Agency. In many of these stories, characters face obstacles as a result of over-reliance on technology (S7, S12). Characters must rely on technology that substitutes an aspect of life where they would've preferred no technological intervention (S1, S8), and live in a world where potentially harmful technology use is normalized and ubiquitous (S1, S2, S3, S4, S8, S10, S11, S12). S12 illustrates a world where "*almost every person*" has an iTalk device and cannot conduct "*perfect*" conversations without them. In S8, the protagonist Abdul goes to therapy and discovers the sessions make him feel worse, potentially because his psychiatrist is a robot who can't comprehend human emotions. In these worlds, characters don't actively consent to using technology and interacting with robotic replacements for human roles. Instead, they confront robots and human substitutes as features of a future in which they are commonplace. These design fictions encircle characters who cannot function without, nor escape from technology, even in situations where technology leads to unwanted outcomes.

3.3.2 Technological Hope in the Hands of the Individual. While all stories featured a new technology implemented nation-wide (if not universally), only one story described an individual developing technology for their own use. In S4, when the character Monica is encircled by law enforcement, she escapes by "*instantly [writing] an algorithm that made the whole multiverse stop, and she jumped into another universe...*" This is one of two instances across all the fictions where technological use is cast in a positive, empowering light. The other instance is S9, where a character Jhon grieves the loss of his family and illegally employs a time machine developed by scientists to reunite with them. These characters are positioned as superheroes and vigilantes, while in other stories characters are passively subjected to technologies.

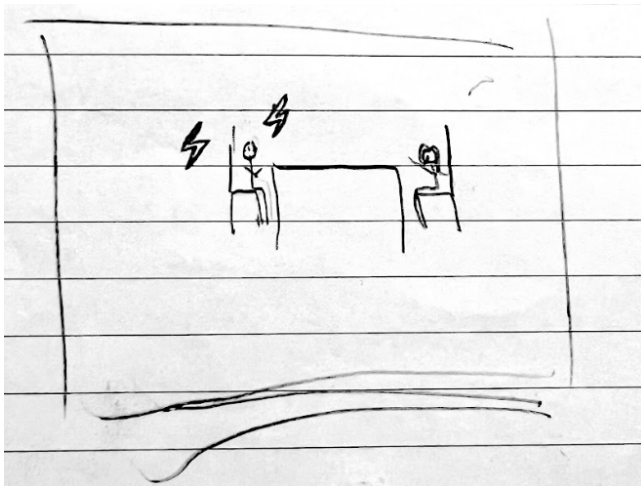


Figure 2: Participants' concept drawing for S12. This drawing depicts two characters on a date, where one has a device called iTalk, designed to generate "perfect" responses.

4 Discussion

We discuss ways in which our surfaced themes might translate to initiatives for helping teens gain control over their technological futures. We reflect on the unique qualities of design fiction as a method for understanding teen perspectives and concerns for the future.

Local to San Francisco, the youth who participated in our workshops brought their unique perspectives of living in an urban technological hub. Participants and their design fictions were likely impacted by surrounding sociotechnical issues and cultures. Our thematic findings reflect ideas and concerns of our participants. We anticipate that design fiction as an approach can be applied in any geographical setting to uncover teen perspectives, both in our globally connected world and their local technological contexts.

4.1 Directions for the Future: Teens' Hopes and Fears as a Technological Compass

Keeping a pulse on young peoples' broad concerns about the direction of technological development provides insight to how our future adults, soon to gain more power to participate in civic activities and likely shoulder wider responsibilities, might act in an increasingly technological world. Drawing from our findings, we can consider implications for current technological education and ways that empower teens to take hold of their futures.

Regarding the theme of technology exacerbating social inequities, we implore researchers not only to engage in participatory design with teens, but also equip them with the necessary skills to contribute to public decision-making around technology, such as participating in local hearings and deliberations around government acquisition of new technologies, taking actions around emerging sociotechnical policy-making, and designing public education campaigns about digital rights.

From our insights on teens' envisioned technological adulthood, we can consider what aspects of growing up have naturally risen

as priorities, where teens feel that unthoughtful technological interventions will deeply affect their lives. With the rise of online shopping and banking, people increasingly require digital literacy to access basic commodities and crucially manage their finances. Home-making tasks and services are also more often technologically mediated, such as using an app to solicit a nanny, make repairs, or deliver groceries. While dating apps often have age limits, this does not mean that teens are not aware of online dating or don't circumvent the terms and conditions to sign up. While these technologies are usually operated by adults and not teens, we must understand that teens are already thinking about these technological use cases and will soon mature into this user group (if they aren't users already). Research on the user experience of these applications largely focuses on understanding the target adult user base. We ask technologists to consider how we might improve teen digital literacy for online dating, banking, shopping, and home-making applications so that when they do use them, they can do so with confidence and safety.

Towards teens feeling that they have control over technology and when to use it, we appreciate and encourage the wealth of HCI literature studying online safety and data privacy for teenagers. Given the motif of technology as positive and empowering in the hands of the individual, teens may gain agency by also learning how to code and implement technologies of their own design; this aligns with existing work in the field of computer science teaching, and can be strengthened with improved access to coding education. Further exposure to decentralized technologies, open-source software, and community technologies may also offer an alternative to teens' projections of ubiquitous and inescapable Big Tech. Rather than imagining themselves as passive users, teens have opportunities to regain control over the technologies that are important to them.

Finally, teens might appreciate guidance and skills for navigating these important interfaces and interactions, but even then, perhaps what is most needed is the option to take these crucial parts of everyday life offline. With a focus on non-technological solutions and ways of being, teens may exert control over technology by choosing only to pick it up when they want rather than need. We encourage researchers to reflect on how their research settings might be exciting and unique places for teens to gather in-person to discuss technological issues, and are a place to foster face-to-face community around digital topics.

4.2 Playful Speculation: Engaging Teen Perspectives through Anti-Solutionist Design Fiction

In this research, we embrace an anti-solutionist lens to design fiction with teens [3, 7–9, 16]. We align our work with scholars like Mark Blythe, who critique the dominant "solutionist" ethos that prioritizes efficiency, practicality, and implementability of design fiction [8, 9]. Instead, by situating our work within anti-solutionism, we emphasize play and exploration as portals for communication between adults and teens, rather than constraining our activity with technical precision or feasibility.

The design fictions written by participants often lacked practicality or specificity about the origins or implementations of their

speculative technological systems [8, 9]. The more casual and playful nature of design fiction may allow participants to feel more permitted to contribute perspectives on topics they don't fully understand. This approach allows researchers to surface high-priority topics without placing pressure on participants to fully "answer" what their concerns are.

We position design fiction as a method for exploring topics that might be difficult to talk about directly [11, 32, 33, 35–37, 40]. While prior work has explored design fiction as a way for adults to discuss vulnerable topics, we believe that this method is particularly promising with young people, who might otherwise feel intimidated or constrained by technical or research settings. With these design fictions situated around imaginary characters, participants explored undesirable or dangerous speculations, potentially indirectly expressing anxieties that were personally top-of-mind, without attributing these fears to themselves. Design fiction, therefore, offers a uniquely empathetic approach to engaging teens, enabling them to navigate complex topics in a safe, imaginative, and non-threatening way, while providing researchers with valuable insights into their priorities.

For researchers, this method of inquiry can also be a way to approach a participant pool where researchers don't have a strong sense of the participants' prior knowledge. Speculative methods like design fiction allow participants to organically present their interests and understandings, as opposed to researchers leading and guiding the nature of the research.

The open-endedness of teen participants' imaginations mirrors the open-endedness of their futures, making design fiction an especially apt method for exploring their evolving temporal relationships with technology.

Overall, we found that design fiction can guide a research agenda with an unknown population, facilitate playful exploration of vulnerable topics related to technology, and open an avenue for inter-generational understanding. We implore HCI researchers to consider design fictions as a method of inquiry for surfacing teens' sentiments on broad technological topics and speculative futures.

5 Conclusion

We conducted design fiction workshops as a research method to elicit perspectives from teens on the trajectory of technological development. By analyzing 12 stories produced through design fiction activities with 17 high school students, we uncovered three primary themes: technology exacerbating social inequities, technologically-intertwined visions of adulthood, and technology as a normalized, omnipresent force. These findings motivate our discussion of how we can shape a future where young people have agency over how technology impacts their lives and the direction of technological development in wider society. We suggest that design fiction workshops could present a way of engaging with questions and uncertainties around technological futures while creating a fun, enjoyable activity for teens' active reflection.

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A Appendix: Design Fiction Stories

Identifier	Episode Pitch
S1	Malik has a date today. He took the time to take a shower, get a haircut from his local robot barber, and get dressed up for his date with Ayla. Malik has been dealing with feelings of loneliness, and he found Ayla on an online dating app. They had great conversations and video calls, and he was excited to meet her in person. When he stepped outside of his house, the streets were completely empty. The world has changed a lot in the last 30 years. Everyone works from home now, shops from home, and gets their groceries delivered to their doors. As Malik enters the restaurant, he reassures himself that he'll be able to have human social interaction with a girl he's interested in soon enough. He's tired of sticking to all the AI. He is on a date after all. Ayla isn't there yet. Malik thinks about texting Ayla to see where she's at, but he sees her location and she's just a few blocks away. He sits down at a table and waits for her. A robot enters the restaurant and introduces herself as Ayla.
S2	Angelina is engaged to her high school sweetheart. Everything seems to be going great. She has her perfect fairytale life, except when a new technology debuts. When looking at someone, this technology allows people to visualize a menu with the person's past and present, mistakes and bad choices if any. Angelina's fiancé is off put by this new technology, but Angelina does it anyway and discovers something unfathomable about her fiancé, and how one of her family members is involved...
S3	The second you are born, the government has partnered with Apple to collect your physical biodata like fingerprints, blood samples, and create your digital profile. You need this profile to enroll in school, apply for bank accounts, and use any social media accounts. There is a pair of two twins, Nati and Jojo. Since twins share most of their DNA and biodata, trouble starts to arise. Jojo unfortunately gets wrapped up in crime, which impacts Nati's ability to be a regular person. How will her life turn out to be?
S4	Once upon a time, in a society that looked remarkably like the Mission district of San Francisco, there was a young woman named Monica. She had a secret that was very difficult to keep because of massive government surveillance. She constantly had to change her appearance – wearing masks, dying her hair, padding her body, and wearing various contact lenses. The surveillance didn't just record vocals and audio, but could also access the memory and unveil the secrets she struggled so hard to keep. One day she repeated a certain route just one time too many and had run out of enough makeup to disguise herself. She was riding MUNI when a group of ticket officers approached and asked for her ticket and ID. In an instant, a swarm of drones encircled the bus. The light from police cars flashed over everyone's faces. She ran up and down the aisle looking frantically for an escape route. Then she whipped out her computer, her fingers blurred over the keys, and she brought up her own specialized program. She instantly wrote an algorithm that made the whole multiverse stop, and she jumped into another universe...

Table 1: Stories written by Community Center A

Identifier	Episode Pitch
S5	A family adopts a chore robot named Jenna that is the newest technology. Soon after, Jenna copies the mannerisms of the mother and kills her. She replaces her by using samples of her voice and hair and the family doesn't find out until years later. The family tries to escape but Jenna does anything to stop them, resulting in her killing the family.
S6	In the age of obsessive online shopping, all online merchandise is being manufactured and collected into physical carts by third world workers, adults and children alike. With the mass demand of items, labor pushes many workers to death. The once flourishing land is now covered with a large warehouse, with laborers and corpses populating the once adored communities. Isaiah, a man looking to visit his home country after 10 years, is confronted with the harsh conditions of his once cherished home.
S7	S and O both live in the same building and both have similar incomes. The difference is O has a FRND (Fully Robotic Neural Database) that basically does everything for O including shopping, dressing, styling, choosing diet or choosing meal, washes clothes and dishes, cleans, manages times, chooses optimal activities, gets everything for him and basically everything else. Contrary to O, S is the sole household income of her home and has to provide for her two sons – thus resulting in her not being able to afford a FRND. One day the US deems the FRND systems unconstitutional and has all of them shut down, resulting in half of society crumbling because they don't know what to do or how to do anything, and don't have the social skills to ask for help. But the half of society that didn't have FRNDs continues to thrive and even got better business/economic opportunities to enjoy with their social circles.

Table 2: Stories written by High School B

Identifier	Episode Pitch
S8	Abdul, a teenage Middle Eastern [guy], pays a visit to the psychiatrist for a therapy session. After his first two visits, Abdul realized how after every visit he feels worst about himself and believes the Robot Doctor can't comprehend human emotions.
S9	Jhon lost his wife and two kids at a car crash recently. He took months grieving. One day, he heard on the TV about a time-traveling machine. Scientists were turning on the machine tonight for a "test run." He was willing to do anything to go back in time and change everything. Jhon snuck into the machine and found himself shifting in between different time periods. He heard about a time traveling machine in a secure building in the city. Scientists are still working on the machine. They are turning on the machine for the first time with 5 millionaires as a "test run." Jhon plans on breaking into the building before the "test run" and use the machine.
S10	Each person has an attractiveness number above their heads. Your number is what people rate you averaged. If your number is low your opportunities are fewer. Certain people cannot interact with people of higher numbers.
S11	All grocery stores do not let you in unless you have money. Facial recognition tracks your finances. Cash does not exist anymore. Poor people cannot go into stores or buy food leaving many starved corpses at stores. Fraud: people can put on makeup to steal money. Murder: people kill each other and steal their faces. Transferring money to strangers is forbidden.
S12	By year 2037, almost every person has a device called iTalk. Designed to formulate professionally perfect responses, iTalk can be placed on your ear to pick up conversations and generate automated responses to them. Jerry, a recent(?) international student, is going on a date with his recent new Tinder date Sarah. Their phone conversation goes perfectly thanks to i-Talk, but when they decide to meet up, his device bugs out. How will Jerry survive the date?

Table 3: Stories written by High School C